

EP Diablos Surge Past Miners 9-1

By BILL COUSINS

Dave Garcia had said he could prove that the University of Texas at El Paso's baseball team is the best team in the country. For a while at Dudley Field Wednesday afternoon, his El Paso Diablos might have agreed.

Then the Diablos erupted for a five-run rally in the fourth inning of their exhibition game with the Miners and coasted to a 9-1 victory.

It was Garcia's reasoning that since the Miners had beaten Arizona and Arizona State, and since the Arizona schools had beaten the California Angles and San Francisco Giants, then U.T. El Paso should have "a nice little ballclub."

That line of thinking may not be too logical; but the product was, in Miner coach Andy Cohen's words, "a pretty good game."

U.T. El Paso starter Mike Kruta held the Texas League club hitless through 3 2-3 in-

nings until his control left him in the fourth. He walked John Balaz and Ron Jackson with two outs, and the Angels farmhands quickly took advantage of the opportunity.

Marty Friedman lined a single to right to score one run, and when Miner right fielder Jim Walsh threw the ball between third and home, allowed Jackson to score and Friedman to move to third.

Frankie George and Carlos Lopez followed with back-to-back doubles for two more runs, and Lopez capped the inning by scoring from second on a Kruta wild pitch.

Pitching and defense were the Diablos' strong suits in their first appearance before home folks. Starter John Andrews didn't allow a baserunner in his three innings of work, and whatever trouble Jim Officer, Ken Barker and Larry Dierks found in relief, the defense was quickly there to bail them out.

The double play combination of Orlando Ramirez and Jerry

Remy drew the most plaudits from Garcia and Andy Cohen.

"That double play combination just killed our scoring chances," Cohen reflected, and Garcia added, "They're going to be great. They are going to make a lot of double plays for us this year."

The Diablos made three twin-killings. The first came in the fourth when Miner Mark Miller struck out on the hit and run, and Diablo catcher Amos Gilcrease gunned down Herb Von Hagen at second.

After Joe Pennies and Terry Dillingham started the fifth with a pair of singles, Remy and Ramirez turned Walsh's ground ball to second into another double play.

The third came in a similar situation in the eighth. David Nance and Von Hagen had led off the inning with a walk and a single, but Mark Miller bounced to Remy to start the DP.

Still, the Miners were able to score as Glenn Villarreal singled in Nance from third

moments later.

The defense wasn't all by the Diablos, either. "Andy's team played well defensively, better than I expected," Garcia said. "Their left fielder (Von Hagen) covered his field well. There were five or six balls that I thought were hits, until one of the Miners surrounded the ball."

Von Hagen was a particular bother to Balaz, the lanky right fielder who led the California League in home runs a year ago. Von Hagen caught Balaz' second inning line drive slanting in from left center, and then threw him out at second on what looked to be a sure double off the fence in the fifth.

The senior from Hamilton, Ohio, also robbed Jackson of an extra-base hit in the sixth when he ranged deep to catch the Diablo third baseman's drive at the wall.

Right fielder Walsh also starred defensively with his running grab of Danny Briggs' line drive in the fifth.

After the fifth, however, the

outcome was never in doubt. Balaz' would-be double in the fifth—where Von Hagen threw him out at second—scored Ramirez, and the Rojas added three more tallies in the seventh off Mike Miller.

Danny Beerbower and Remy were on base with singles when Ramirez plated them both with a double off the wall in left center. Briggs followed with a similar double to knock in Ramirez.

The only other U.T. El Paso threat came in the seventh when Downing led off with a single and pinch runner Sam Cox was moved to third on Terry Dillingham's double over Frankie George in left.

Barker then went to work, striking out Walsh and making Jim Brundage pop to Remy at second.

Wednesday afternoon's game was the first time the city's professional and collegiate clubs had met, and it served as a warm-up for league battle for both.

The Diablos, of course, open

their Texas League season at 7 p.m., Friday against the Amarillo Giants, while the Miners travel to Albuquerque for a three-game Western Athletic Conference Southern Division set with the University of New Mexico.

DIABLOS	ab	r	h	bi	MINERS	ab	r	h	bi
Remy 2b	4	1	1	0	Von Hagen rf	3	0	0	0
Ramirez ss	3	2	1	2	MaMiller 2b	4	0	0	0
Briggs lb	4	0	1	1	Villarreal 2b	4	0	2	1
Balaz rf	3	1	1	0	Downing dh	4	0	2	0
Jackson 3b	3	1	0	0	Cox pr	0	0	0	0
Friedman cf	2	1	1	1	Pennies cf	4	0	0	0
George lf	4	1	1	1	Dillingham lb	0	0	0	0
Lopez dh	2	1	1	4					
Beerbower dh	0	0	0	0	Walsh rf	3	0	0	0
2	1	1	0	0	Stringer ph	1	0	0	0
Gilcrease c	2	0	0	0	Brundage c	4	0	0	0
Jordan c	0	0	0	0	Nance ss	2	1	0	0
Andrews p	0	0	0	0	Kruta p	0	0	0	0
Officer p	0	0	0	0	Knox p	0	0	0	0
Barker p	0	0	0	0	Miller p	0	0	0	0
Dierks p	0	0	0	0	Hilton p	0	0	0	0
Totals	31	9	7	11	Totals	31	1	1	1

Miners		000	000	010	-1
Diablos		000	510	30x	-9
E-walsh, DP	Diablos	1	LOB	-Miners	
7	Diablos	2	2b-George, Lopez,		
	Dillingham,		Ramirez,		
	SB		Balaz,		
			Briggs,		

Kruta (L)		IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO
Knox		2	1	1	1	1	1
Miller		1	4	3	3	0	0
Hilton		1	0	0	0	1	1
Andrews (W)		3	0	0	0	2	2
Officer		2	4	0	0	0	2
Barker		2	4	0	1	2	2
Dierks		2	3	1	1	2	2
WP	-Kruta	T-2	704	A-250			

ABA Raids Field San Diego Q's Draft Gus Bailey

NEW YORK (AP) — The American Basketball Association, drafting without limitations or hesitations, chose an assortment of players Wednesday that included high school senior Moses Malone, Rhodes Scholarship winner Tom McMillen, veteran pro

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Bob Kauffman and National Basketball Association scoring champion Bob McAdoo.

Malone's selection perhaps caused the biggest shockwaves at the ABA's three-ring circus, which began with the drafting of players from the rival NBA, was followed by the announcement of collegiate players chosen in a secret draft last month and ended with the completion of the college draft

whom left college early and became outstanding pros in our league," said Arnie Ferrin, the Stars' general manager.

While Malone's selection caused the biggest furor, the ABA's choice of 50 players—each ABA team took five—from the NBA also created quite a stir.

The honor of being the first NBA player drafted by the ABA



DOUBLE OUT — El Paso Diablo second baseman Jerry Remy, left, puts the tag on U.T. El Paso's Herb Von Hagen who was caught stealing in the third inning of Wednesday's exhibition game at Dudley Field. The play at second capped double play when Miner Mark Miller struck out and Diablo catcher Amos Gilcrease threw to Remy to nail Von Hagen.

—(Times Staff Photo by Luis Villalobos)

Fisher

iddle distance grand prix, which .000 to the winner.

leased with that race." The 5-foot-10 man said, "I don't like to run the le, but outdoors I have room to run."